

AVOID PEER PRESSURE

Many people make the mistake of following the MBA pack and squander their chances to grab better opportunities elsewhere



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There are a number of characteristics that define a world-class management programme. Such a programme would have high quality international faculty, who are both great teachers and researchers, exploring the frontiers of knowledge. It would have a curriculum that includes both developed and emerging market perspectives, and is in close contact with the industry in order to be flexible and relevant to changes and forthcoming trends. Its students would be intelligent, dynamic and entrepreneurial, and would clearly be the future leaders who will spearhead innovative methods of doing business in a sustainable and inclusive way.

The Indian education system is caught in a time warp. Apart from incremental changes that have been patchy at best, we have not responded to changing needs and times. We need to revamp our system in response to global trends and utilise the huge talent pool that we are so fortunate to have. Over and above bookish knowledge, we also have to emphasise quality, practical

experience and innovative thinking. Above all, we need to lay the foundation for a solution-based mindset and high ethical standards. This is true for education at all levels, and management education would naturally reinforce these values.

A large and diverse country like India needs a large number of high quality B-schools to meet the demands of growth as there is a yawning gap between supply and demand. While we have probably the largest number of B-schools in a country, there are only a few quality institutions. In the future, this number is likely to grow but it may not meet the requirements. We have to explore all avenues, new partnerships and models to establish exemplary institutions in India. The Indian School of Business has ushered in a new paradigm of management education in India. I hope there will be many more soon.

Our country needs many high quality programmes not only in management but in all other educational areas as well. Private-public partnerships and private enterprise should be encouraged. Instead of regulators forcing certain parameters to be followed, the government should define the standards of excellence and establish quality ratings for educational institutions. The market and the people should be allowed to decide what works and what does not.

MBA has always been seen as the route to a highly successful management career but I would urge students to think twice before jumping on to the bandwagon. A successful career can be made only when you are able to contribute fully. That can be done only if the objectives match one's innate potential and aptitudes. Many young people make the mistake of following the pack due to peer pressure and realise rather late in life that they have squandered their chances to be great. Interest and inner security are important to make the right choices for oneself.

The writer is the dean of Indian School of Business

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